
title: "Fears are widespread about data centre impacts on Canada's water, environment: poll - National | Globaln" subtitle: "Category: Diesel Generators & Fuel Spills Near Water | Evidence ID: #227" date: "Archived: 2026-10-04 20:23" ---

- **Original URL:** <https://globalnews.ca/news/11971131/ai-data-centres-environment-impact/>
 - **Research Category:** Diesel Generators & Fuel Spills Near Water
 - **Archival File:** 227_globalnews_ca_news_11971131_ai-data-centres-environment.pdf
 - **Extraction Status:** Full Web Transcript PDF
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Source Content

A large majority of Canadians in a recent poll said they worry that artificial intelligence data centres will hike their power bills and harm the environment. In the Leger poll, 81 per cent of respondents said they are concerned about the prospect of data centres leading to spikes in their household electricity bills. A similar share, 79 per cent, said they worry about the environmental impacts, such as the large amounts of electricity and water data centres consume, as well as their greenhouse gas emissions. When the survey touched on the issue of data sovereignty and asked respondents whether they support building data centres to back Canadian-based AI services, more were in favour than were opposed. Just under half, 46 per cent, said building the facilities to give Canada more control over data would be a good thing, while 37 per cent said it would be a bad thing. "We're seeing evidence that there is a bit of a divided opinion amongst Canadians regarding the construction of these data centres around the country," said Andrew Enns, Leger's executive vice-president for Central Canada. Get daily National news That division also emerged when respondents were asked how they felt about the prospect of AI data centres being built in their own provinces. While 44 per cent said they would support such a development, 42 per cent said they would oppose it. The online survey of 1,505 people was conducted between July 10 and July 13. The Canadian Research Insights Council, an industry organization that promotes polling standards, says online surveys cannot be assigned a margin of error because they do not randomly sample the population. Leger also found awareness of data centres among Canadians was relatively high — 62 per cent said they had heard of them. The respondents were also asked about the supply of electricity to AI data centres. Most, 58 per cent, said provincial governments or electricity providers should supply electricity for AI data centres. Just under a third said they should do so only if the companies pay the full cost of the power and any required infrastructure. Another 31 per cent said data centre companies shouldn't be able to access public electricity and should be responsible for meeting their own energy needs. There are plans to dramatically expand data centre capacity in Canada and the vast majority of that work is set to take place in Alberta, where the centres could draw their power from natural gas plants and not the electrical grid. Public opposition to data centres has emerged across the country — including in Alberta — and in June, Manitoba Premier Wab Kinew rejected plans for a massive data centre southeast of Winnipeg. @Ali you are full of crp !!! and nothing more than a CCP troll. WAKE UP Canada the Chinese CCP are NOT our friends or allies. They ARE our greatest threat. @ Sharon C the Chinese CCP

are insidious in their methods for gaining influence and control within a country. One such method is their belt and road initiative wherein they build infrastructure and pay for the work then use that as leverage to gain power and control over a government and an economy. They used it to great success in Africa and now they will use it, although a bit more subtle in Canada, it is aimed at the same objective, gaining influence, power and control over our country. Are they though? The liberals have been praising China, so I don't think they would try to undermine our innovation and economy. You realize the anti data-centre movement starts with funding from China. Right? They want to win the race. And are investing in techniques to slow down Western advantages. The sky is falling, the sky is falling! Too late, it fell Twenty paragraphs to say nothing, to repeat what anyone with a brain cell knows, cheesewiz Christ, SHADUP! @For AI Government and just like what you would replace actual human beings with ... your intelligence is totally artificial and should be subject to scrutiny. I'm all for AI and believe it should be used to replace actual politicians, public service workers, police and judges. The efficiency, accuracy, cost savings and societal benefits are needed. Ai should be regulated but misinformation trolls like me should not Thx Global @ Ron Johnson AI Data Centers are a completely different animal than the horseless carriage debate. The Data Centers are an existential threat to a crumbling infrastructure and as a direct result of that a society totally dependent on electricity to provide the food resources and electrical supply to sustain it will suffer in numerous ways from huge increases in domestic and industrial electricity rates to possible brown outs or black outs of entire neighbourhoods or even towns to ensure supply is available for the Data Centers. That will result in many deaths from heat in summer and cold in winter as well as reduced food supply and the resulting inflationary price increases for food. Then of course to compound the whole thing we have Carney allowing a CCP owned company to start shipping EV's into our market, at limited numbers at first, but inevitably those numbers will grow, which will in itself create further electrical grid issues. All in all not a good situation coming to Canada soon. The only thing that could possibly alleviate the problems would be the construction of nuclear power across Canada. But that would take the political will and backbone that is lacking in most provincial governments and definitely in the current Carney Liberal government. Hang onto your hats folks it is going to be a very rough ride. From doing data Trace Routes, Global data centers are located in New Jersey in the USA. This Canadian data centers pushback is to maintain the USA dominance in data centers which will keep Canadians relying on the USA. These centres take up a lot of resources and cause noise for neighbours. If these problems are taken care of, I'm in favour. Also AI should be regulated. @Tom What's the matter? Just because you have the attention span of a flea, from too much screen time? Actually there was a bit of actual info in there...but like most your too lazy too read? Yup. There were a lot of troglodytes against the Horseless Carriage because they would put people out of work, would cause accidents because they were faster, create more noise, smelly exhaust and other detriments to society. If we let those people have their way back in the early 1900s we would be still riding horses today. The AI government that rules the world will be located in ALBERTA, yesssss! If only Canadians were this passionate about protesting against other problems we have That shows media is not doing a good enough job of getting the facts out. Data Centers do not produce environmental heat. They do generate heat, but it is released into the air via radiators not as water heat. They rely on power generated by natural gas electrical plants. That is the electrical grid. – why the disinformation? Why would you even ask if data centers should supply their own power? From where???? And how exactly would a province provide power. They are a government, not a power producer. – insanity. Fck Ai. Burn data centers down. @Dave

I guess you mom and dad pay for electricity so you can go ahead make stupid comments What a loser Who writes a ten paragraph comment, grab a friggin brain! No more saddles or buggy whips, the horror of it all, the horror! Tinfoil sales are up sharply at this point. The Oligarchs who have their dirty hands in these Data Centers don't care. No Jobs, etc. Only Robotics. Has anyone noticed how fast they're being built against the Demands of Canadians and Globally? The wealthy including our Governments, Federal and Provincial are Ignoring the people's Demands. What can be done at this point? This is getting real Scary :(It's just the latest thing to get in an uproar about. Look at the picture they post? Your electric bill will grow Brownouts and/or blackouts will also follow because our electric grid experiences trouble with every little storm Imagine what will happen with a data center running continuously Building AI data centers in Alberta could put upward pressure on residential electricity bills, according to statements from the Alberta Electric System Operator (AESO). However, the actual impact on your wallet depends entirely on how these facilities are powered and how provincial regulations manage the sudden surge in demand. The primary cost drivers, offsetting factors, and legislative interventions shaping your utility bills involve several key components: ⚡ Why Bills Could Rise • Grid Strain and Power Demand: AI data centers consume immense amounts of electricity. The AESO has noted that connecting massive new loads to the grid before new generation is built forces the existing fleet to work harder, which naturally drives wholesale market prices up. • Natural Gas Market Competition: Because Alberta's strategy heavily favors natural gas to power these facilities, critics like the Pembina Institute warn that increased industrial demand could expose consumers to intense market competition for natural gas. This can trickle down as higher home heating and electricity bills. • Infrastructure and Plant Construction Costs: Building new power plants and transmission infrastructure to support massive loads requires multi-billion-dollar capital investments. In a deregulated market, these staggering upfront costs can ultimately be passed down to ratepayers. ⚖️ Why Bills Might Stay Protected (or Even Drop) • The "Bring Your Own Power" Mandate: To protect everyday consumers, the Alberta government has pushed a policy requiring large data centers to supply their own electricity off-grid or build dedicated on-site generation. For example, Meta's massive private investment in Sturgeon County includes fully funding its own adjacent gas-and-renewable generation. • Sharing Transmission Costs: Government officials point out that when massive corporations fully fund new grid infrastructure, it spreads the system's fixed transmission costs across much larger power users. This could theoretically reduce transmission fees on an average Albertan's utility bill by up to six per cent. • Market Incentives for New Supply: In Alberta's unique investor-owned market, a period of higher prices acts as a magnet for developers to build new generation rapidly. According to AESO market logic, this incoming wave of new supply eventually drives wholesale prices back down. 📜 Government Intervention: Bill 12 To further insulate Albertans from subsidizing corporate tech infrastructure, the province introduced Bill 12 (the Data Centre Levy). Starting at the end of 2026, grid-connected facilities using 75 megawatts or more must pay a 1% to 2% tax on their computing hardware. This levy is specifically designed to capture provincial revenue from international tech giants and offset the structural strain placed on the electrical grid. Data centres are the biggest imminent threat to contribute to coming huge increases in electricity costs. Also a contributor to your electricity bill skyrocketing will be the increased number of EV's given that the numbers of CCP owned vehicles

will undoubtedly increase in Canada more than the small number initially announced by Carney. Not only will the cost of electricity skyrocket but also the downstream costs of food production and manufacture that rely on electricity will increase and in the end the consumer ... you and I Will pay the full costs. Data centres are just the canary in the coal mine that show us what is going to happen with electricity costs. God help us all !!! The sky is falling,the sky is falling! A symptom of government rushing towards the latest shiny object. Dave – “Let me know when the hypocrites give up their data plans”. You have no idea what you are talking about. You are confusing data transfer to my phone or home electronics with centres that process data before transitting it to my phone across my carriers hardware network. This is AI data centres which are massive resource hogs. If your governments are contemplating rolling blackouts to avoud catastrophic electricity grid failures, they should not be entertaining AI data centres at all. Let me know when the hypocrites give up their data plans